

Projected Health Impact of Achieving WHO Targets for Cardiovascular Risk-Factor Control

Work in Progress

WHO · University of Washington

August 2026

Study Overview

Aim 1: Research Questions

Central Question

What is the projected **burden-of-disease impact** of achieving the WHO cardiovascular risk-factor control targets by **2030**?

Sub-questions driving the analysis:

1. How many **cardiovascular events** could be averted?
2. How many **CVD deaths** could be prevented by 2030 and beyond?
3. How would **life-years, YLLs, YLDs, and DALYs** change under joint achievement of:
 - 150M additional people with controlled hypertension
 - $\geq 50\%$ lipid-lowering therapy coverage
 - 80% BP control among people with diabetes
 - **80% validated BP device availability**

Scope

190 countries · Ages 20–95 · 2026–2050 ·
Multiple CVD causes · WHO Target Scenarios

Intervention start: 2026

Model calibrated to 2019 baseline. First year of target scale-up effects entering the projection is **2026**. Aim 1: Modelling Study